

Drake Thorne

Platform Engineer | Haymarket, NSW

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SUMMARY

Platform Engineer with 4+ years of experience designing, automating, and operating network and infrastructure across on-premises and cloud environments. Experienced with building scalable automation platforms – Ansible, Python, and Terraform over AWS, EKS, and NetBox – using Git-based CI/CD, turning manual network and infra workflows into repeatable, self-service systems.

EXPERIENCE

Platform Engineer (Networks) | Nine Entertainment

Aug 2024 – Present

- Developed and delivered the company's first Mist-based network automation, building frameworks for multiple full-site EVPN-VXLAN spine-leaf fabrics across Juniper QFX/EX and Fortinet platforms, leveraging Juniper Mist, Ansible, Python, and GitHub Actions. Automated traffic draining, BGP policies, peering, route maps, ESI-LAG, IRB/VRF management, and port allocation.
- Developed and maintained Ansible automation frameworks and API-driven workflows (REST API/GraphQL) integrating NetBox, Infoblox, LogicMonitor, ServiceNow, Cisco ISE, and Cisco Catalyst Center, enabling scalable infrastructure management across 1500+ network devices while reducing manual toil.
- Built and established the team's OpenTofu module library, provisioning resources for NetBox, Infoblox UDDI, Cloudflare, and AWS.
- Developed a reusable CI/CD pipeline adopted across 100% of the team's OpenTofu repositories, running on self-hosted Actions runners on EKS – showing planned diffs on pull requests and applying resource changes on merge.
- Engineered repeatable microservices deployments on Amazon EKS via Helm charts and Kubernetes manifests. Included NetBox, Oxidized, Ansible AWX, and self-hosted Docker Registry with pull-through cache.
- Developed event-driven, serverless AWS pipelines connecting Basware and Microsoft D365, using AWS Lambdas written in Golang. Managed infrastructure such as EventBridge, SQS, API Gateway, S3, and IAM roles via OpenTofu.
- Built and maintained Docker images for development containers and production execution environments using Ansible Builder and Git-based CI/CD workflows via GitHub Actions, publishing multi-architecture ARM64/AMD64 images to Amazon ECR.
- Led the end-to-end migration of enterprise DHCP infrastructure from Windows DHCP Server to Infoblox NIOS across all sites, developing Ansible automation for IPAM migration, DHCP scope provisioning, and VXLAN gateway updates. Provided post-migration operational support.
- Automated Amazon RDS lifecycle management processes using Ansible, reducing manual database provisioning and maintenance effort by approximately 50%.
- Designed and deployed automated ERSPAN unicast monitoring workflows integrated with ExtraHop, increasing network traffic visibility to approximately 80% of RX traffic.
- Diagnosed and resolved pod/node failures, performance bottlenecks, and cluster resource constraints across containerised workloads on Amazon EKS, using Grafana, Vector, and ClickHouse for observability.

Systems Administrator | Fin Design + Effects

Apr 2023 – Aug 2024

- Designed and delivered a centralized monitoring and telemetry platform across 500+ nodes using Graylog, Zabbix, Grafana, and Slack integrations, improving observability and reducing incident response times.
- Developed Ansible-based automation for Linux fleet management across 50+ nodes, including configuration management, Cron jobs, patching, and operational maintenance.
- Built and implemented secure remote access infrastructure using Duo MFA, RADIUS/Active Directory authentication, L2TP/IPsec VPNs, Apache, and Nginx reverse proxy technologies.
- Managed hybrid infrastructure environments spanning Windows Server, VMware, TrueNAS, Google Cloud Platform, and Linux systems, supporting business-critical production workloads.

- Designed, deployed, and maintained Layer 2 and Layer 3 network infrastructure across Brocade and Cisco platforms, including VLANs, VRFs, LAG/LACP, NAT, and routing instances.
- Implemented network security controls through ACL management, Barracuda firewall administration, and PowerShell-based encryption automation to strengthen infrastructure security posture.

Systems Administrator | Nielsen

Oct 2022 – Mar 2023

- Managed large-scale Active Directory (users, security groups, group policy, DNS, DHCP), and Cisco ACLs/VLANs across the corporate environment.
- Configured Zabbix monitoring and alerting for infrastructure health, and automated operational tasks with PowerShell.
- Rebuilt and patched Windows Servers (2008-2019) and workstations across on-prem and private data centre sites via iDRAC, with SIEM-based log analysis and 24/7 on-call support.

EDUCATION

Diploma of Information Technology | Macquarie University

Graduated 2022

WAM: 81.875 (Distinction)

Academic Integrity Certification | Macquarie Association of Computing Students (MACS)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, Bash, PowerShell, REST APIs/GraphQL

Automation & IaC: Ansible, AWX, Terraform/OpenTofu, Git, GitHub Actions

Containers & Platforms: Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Linux

Cloud: AWS (EKS, EC2, ECR, RDS, S3)

Networking: NetBox, Cisco (IOS, NX-OS, ISE, Catalyst Center), Juniper (Junos, Evo, Mist), FortiGate, Brocade, EVPN-VXLAN, BGP

Monitoring & Operations: Grafana, ClickHouse, LogicMonitor, Infoblox, Wireshark, Nginx, Apache